

T H E

Postnatal Protocol

RECOVER. REBUILD. THRIVE.

BY

Swetha Ashok

WWW.THEGUTGURU.CO.IN

GUTGURU PROTOCOL

Table of Contents

01 Recovery Nutrition Priorities

02 Common Postnatal Nutrient Deficits

03 Recovery Foods & What to Avoid

04 The Postnatal Plate Formula

05 Common Postnatal Mistakes

06 Myth Busters

CHAPTER 01

Postnatal Recovery Nutrition

The postpartum period depletes nearly every nutrient system — and most women are significantly under-supported nutritionally.



Iron Rebuilding

Childbirth causes significant blood loss. Combined with the iron demands of 9 months of pregnancy, postpartum iron deficiency is nearly universal without deliberate replenishment.



Breastfeeding Demands

Breastfeeding requires an additional 500 kcal/day above pre-pregnancy intake. Under-eating while nursing depletes maternal nutrient stores — not milk supply.



Postnatal Mood & B12

B12 and omega-3 deficiency are strongly linked to postpartum depression. Nutritional support is a legitimate and evidence-backed part of postnatal mental health care.

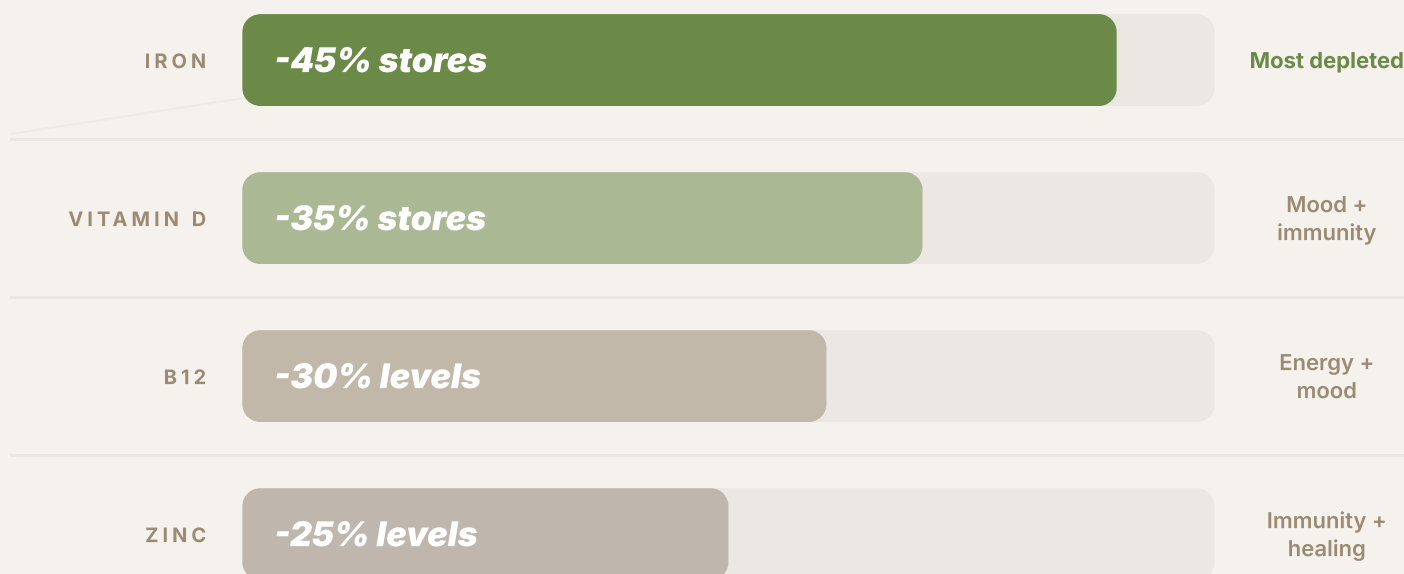


Hormonal Recalibration

Oestrogen and progesterone drop sharply after delivery. Adequate dietary fat, protein, and micronutrients support the slow hormonal recovery that takes 6–12 months.

CHAPTER 02

Postnatal *Nutrient* Depletion



Iron deficiency postpartum affects up to 50% of new mothers globally — yet is routinely under-tested and under-treated. Fatigue in the first 6 months postpartum is frequently iron depletion, not just "new mother tiredness".

KEY TAKEAWAY



Til (sesame) + vitamin C together is one of the most effective postpartum iron-recovery food combinations — a sesame ladoo with amla or lime activates non-haem iron absorption by up to 3×.

CHAPTER 03

Recovery Foods vs Depletors

The traditional Indian postpartum diet (ajwain, methi, til, ghee) is not superstition — it is evidence-aligned recovery nutrition.

REBUILD

Recovery Superfoods

These replenish iron, B12, DHA, zinc, and support lactation.

Til (sesame) laddoo Methi laddoo Moringa
Ragi Rajma Dates Amla Ghee
Eggs Ajwain water Curd

LIMIT

Nutrient Depletors

These slow recovery, deplete nutrients, or interfere with lactation and hormone recalibration.

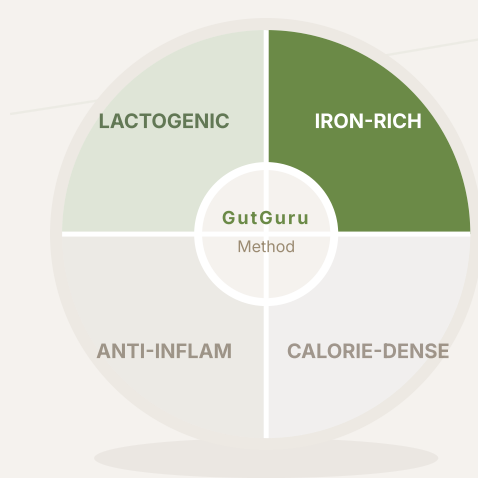
Crash dieting Alcohol Excess caffeine
Fat-free diets Highly processed food
Sugar-heavy snacks

Traditional Indian postpartum foods — methi laddoo, til chikki, ajwain water, panjiri — are clinically coherent lactation and recovery support. They are evidence-aligned, not myths.

CHAPTER 04

The Postnatal Plate Formula

THE GUTGURU RECOVERY METHOD

**Iron-Rebuilding Foods**

Til, ragi, dates, moringa, rajma, methi

+

**Lactogenic Foods**

Methi, jeera, ajwain, garlic, oats, dalia

+

**Anti-Inflammatory**

Turmeric milk, ginger, walnuts, flaxseed

+

**Calorie-Dense Foods**

Ghee, nuts, coconut, banana, full-fat dairy

EXAMPLE MEAL

Methi laddoo + ragi roti + moringa dal + curd**Breastfeeding: +500 kcal/day above pre-pregnancy intake**

DAILY CALORIE REQUIREMENT WHILE NURSING

CHAPTER 05

Common *Postnatal* Mistakes

**Crash dieting to lose baby weight**

Undereating postpartum depletes breast milk quality, worsens postnatal mood, and slows bone and tissue recovery.

**Avoiding ghee and healthy fats for weight loss**

Healthy fats are essential for hormone recovery, joint lubrication, brain health, and the fat content of breast milk.

**Not eating enough total calories while breastfeeding**

Breastfeeding burns approximately 500 extra kcal/day. Undereating forces the body to cannibalize maternal nutrient stores to make milk.

**Skipping traditional recovery foods as "old-fashioned"**

Methi laddoo, til chikki, and ajwain water are iron-rich, lactogenic, and anti-inflammatory — they are clinical foods, not superstition.

**Ignoring mental health nutrition in the postpartum period**

B12 deficiency, iron deficiency, and omega-3 deficiency are all independent risk factors for postpartum depression.

CHAPTER 06

Quick Myth Busters

MYTH Breastfeeding automatically makes you lose weight.

TRUTH **Breastfeeding burns ~500 extra kcal/day but also increases appetite significantly.** Under-eating while nursing depletes the mother's nutrient stores — not a safe weight loss strategy.

MYTH The postnatal diet should be bland and oil-free.

TRUTH **Healthy fats are essential for postnatal hormone recovery, joint healing, and breast milk fat content.** Ghee and coconut oil are therapeutic in the postpartum period.

MYTH Iron supplements are enough to rebuild postpartum iron.

TRUTH **Food-based iron (til, ragi, moringa, dates) combined with Vitamin C dramatically outperforms supplementation alone** in bioavailability — especially for non-haem iron.

TAKE THIS HOME

Your 3 Quick Wins

Three specific actions you can start this week — no equipment, no cost, measurable results.

1

Make One Sesame-Based Food Every Day

Add til (sesame) to at least one meal daily — til chutney, til laddoo, or til mixed into dal or sabzi. Sesame is one of the highest plant-based iron sources available and is lactogenic. This is your cheapest iron-rebuilding food.

FOR THE NEXT 2 WEEKS

2

Eat Something Within 30 Minutes of Waking

Do not skip breakfast — especially while breastfeeding. Breastfeeding mothers who skip the morning meal lose energy and milk supply faster. A banana + 2 eggs or a bowl of dalia takes 5 minutes and is sufficient to anchor the day.

EVERY SINGLE MORNING

3

Test Your Ferritin — Not Just Haemoglobin

Ask your doctor for a **serum ferritin test** alongside the standard haemoglobin check. Ferritin measures stored iron — which depletes months before haemoglobin falls. Postpartum fatigue is frequently ferritin deficiency that a standard blood test misses.

WITHIN THE NEXT 2 WEEKS

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READY TO PERSONALIZE?

Book a 1-on-1 Consultation

Get a clinical nutrition plan tailored to your postpartum recovery and breastfeeding, body, and lifestyle.

 www.thegutguru.co.in



+91 9769921409



gutguru.swetha@gmail.com